

Thursday, 17 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Heavy drizzle

21° 15°

BIRMINGHAM

Heavy drizzle

18° 13°

MANCHESTER

Light rain

16° 12°

GLASGOW

Light rain

14° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

UK inflation has risen again, pushed higher by increasing petrol and diesel prices.

Summer holidays and ongoing disruption to global oil supplies, caused by the Middle East conflict, are being blamed for the price growth. This will be unwelcome news for households already struggling with the cost of living.

ECONOMY · UK

2

The government has offered an extra five hundred million pounds to schools in England, in a bid to avoid a teachers' pay strike.

The increased offer significantly reduces the prospect of industrial action by the country's largest teaching union. This will be a relief for parents and pupils hoping for an uninterrupted school year.

EDUCATION · UK

3

New claims have emerged from a book written by Earl Spencer, the brother of the late Princess Diana.

He alleges that King Charles believed Diana would be forgotten 'soon enough' after her death. Buckingham Palace has not yet commented on the claims, which are likely to generate significant discussion.

ROYALS · UK

4

A suspect in the infamous 'Putney pusher' incident has been found dead at home.

Nicholas Brandram was a suspect in the incident nine years ago, where a woman was shoved into the path of a bus. The development brings a new twist to a long-running and shocking case.

CRIME · UK

5

A former police officer has been jailed over a 'toxic' WhatsApp culture, after asking for a suspect's sex video.

The ex-officer, who wanted to show the footage to 'the lads from footy', has been sentenced to four years in prison. This case highlights ongoing concerns about standards and behaviour within the police force.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Pokémon fans are queuing up for the release of the highly anticipated 30th-anniversary trading cards.**
Avid collectors are calling this 'the biggest day in a decade' for the Japanese trading card game. It's a huge moment for fans eager to get their hands on the special edition cards.
ON AIR – Are you a fan of Pokémon? Do you remember collecting the cards as a kid, or are you still collecting today?
GAMING · TODAY
- 2 British wrestler Will Ospreay is set to headline AEW's 'All In' show at Wembley this weekend.**
Known as the 'aerial assassin', Ospreay has overcome a serious injury to reach this career-defining moment. It's a massive event for wrestling fans, with a British star taking centre stage.
ON AIR – Are you planning to watch the wrestling at Wembley this weekend? Have you ever been to a live wrestling event?
WRESTLING · THIS WEEKEND
- 3 Fans and critics alike are impressed after the big preview of the blockbuster video game, Grand Theft Auto 6.**
The official look at the highly anticipated game has left many eager for its release. It's one of the biggest upcoming titles in the gaming world, and the hype is building.
ON AIR – Are you a fan of Grand Theft Auto? What are you hoping to see in the new game?
GAMING · COMING SOON
- 4 Foden's Band, known as one of the world's best brass bands, has trumpeted its 14th win as Britain's best.**
The band continues to add titles to its impressive collection, cementing its reputation. It's a testament to their dedication and musical talent.
ON AIR – Do you enjoy brass band music? What's your favourite instrument in a brass band?
MUSIC · RECENTLY
- 5 Turner Prize winner Keith Tyson has unveiled his new vision for his hometown.**
He hopes to create a space for exhibitions, education, and community engagement. It's an exciting project that could bring significant cultural benefits to the area.
ON AIR – What kind of art do you enjoy? Do you think it's important for artists to give back to their hometowns?
ART · FUTURE

On the schedule

- 1 **The controversy surrounding the VAR decision in the Manchester derby continues to rumble on.**
 Erling Haaland's winning goal was allowed to stand, despite widespread debate about the decision. Fans and pundits are still discussing what led to the error and its impact on the game.
ON AIR – What's your take on the VAR decision in the Manchester derby? Should the goal have stood?
 FOOTBALL · UK

- 2 **Harry Brook's sensational century helped England crush Sri Lanka in the latest T20I.**
 Brook hit 114 not out from just 42 balls, the joint-second fastest hundred by an Englishman in a T20I. England won by 119 runs after bowling out Sri Lanka, with a fantastic performance all round.
ON AIR – What a knock from Harry Brook! Is he one of the most exciting talents in English cricket right now?
 CRICKET · UK

- 3 **Warwickshire have gone top of the County Championship table after beating Essex in just two days.**
 The Bears wrapped up a quick win, boosting their title hopes significantly. It's a strong statement from Warwickshire as the season progresses.
ON AIR – Are you following the County Championship this season? Who do you think will lift the trophy?
 CRICKET · UK

- 4 **Hibernian have sacked head coach David Gray just six games into the Scottish Premiership season.**
 The decision brings an end to the former captain's 12-year stay at Easter Road. It's an early change for Hibs, who will now be looking for a new direction.
ON AIR – Do you think it was the right decision to sack David Gray so early in the season?
 FOOTBALL · UK

- 5 **Formula 1 is increasing the number of sprint races for the 2027 World Championship, including one at Monaco.**
 The number of sprint races will go up from six to ten, offering more short-form racing action. It's a big change for the F1 calendar and could bring even more excitement to the sport.
ON AIR – Are you a fan of sprint races in F1? Do you think having more will be a good thing?
 FORMULA 1 · FUTURE

Quick hits

- 1 The simple pleasure of 'window watching' is making a big comeback, as more people are finding calm in observing the world outside.**
It's about taking a moment to notice the changing light, people walking by, or even just the leaves on a tree. Many are discovering it's a lovely way to feel connected without leaving the comfort of home.
- 2 A charming trend is emerging: 'library book swaps' in unexpected community spots.**
Think small, decorated boxes appearing in local parks, outside cafes, or even on village greens, filled with books for people to borrow and exchange freely. It's a wonderful way to share stories and discover new authors.
- 3 The delightful art of 'identifying distant bird calls' is charming its way into gardens across the UK.**
Armed with apps and keen ears, nature enthusiasts are learning to distinguish the songs of various garden birds. It's a lovely, mindful way to connect with local wildlife right on your doorstep.
- 4 Families are rediscovering the joy of 'traditional board game nights' with a twist.**
Instead of screen time, many are dedicating an evening each week to classic board games, often making their own snacks and creating themed music playlists. It's all about quality time together.
- 5 A new study suggests that the gentle sound of 'rain on a conservatory roof' is one of Britain's most cherished calming sounds.**
It seems the rhythmic patter creates a wonderfully cosy and peaceful atmosphere, perfect for relaxing with a cup of tea. Who needs expensive spa music when nature provides the best soundtrack?
- 6 The unexpected hobby of 'collecting interesting pebbles and stones' from local walks is gaining popularity.**
People are finding beauty in the natural shapes, colours, and textures of ordinary stones, often arranging them artfully at home or using them in craft projects. It's a free and fulfilling outdoor pursuit.
- 7 Cafes and bakeries are introducing 'mystery pastry boxes' at the end of the day to reduce food waste.**
For a small price, customers get a selection of delicious, unsold baked goods. It's a fun surprise, helps the environment, and means you get a bargain treat!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of tea will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: ...GIVING THE BOX A LITTLE SNIFF, JUST TO SEE IF IT SMELLS 'TEATASTIC'!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new film, especially if it's a much-anticipated release. What is it?

ANSWER: ...ENSURING ALL THE CUSHIONS ON THE SOFA ARE PERFECTLY FLUFFED AND ALIGNED, JUST SO!

TALK TOPIC

- **Do you remember when you first learned to ride a bicycle, or perhaps taught someone else?**
It's such a universal experience, full of wobbly moments and triumphant rides! What's your favourite memory associated with learning to cycle?

- **We all have that 'one particular type of sandwich' that, no matter what, is always your go-to comfort food, perfect for any occasion, don't we?**
Whether it's a classic cheese and pickle, a simple ham, or something a bit more adventurous, what's your ultimate comfort sandwich?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of pugs is actually called a 'grumble'.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies only have a lifespan of a single day, which is why they flutter so quickly.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£24 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£24 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's first public aquarium opened in London's Regent's Park in 1853.
- The inventor of the traffic light was Garrett Morgan, an African American inventor who patented it in 1923.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one hundredth of a second.
- The smell of freshly cut grass is actually a plant distress call.
- The highest mountain in the British Isles is Ben Nevis, located in Scotland.
- Cows don't actually have upper front teeth; they have a dental pad instead.
- The first mobile phone call in the UK was made in 1985.
- The collective noun for a group of badgers is a 'cete'.

On this day

Day 260 of the year, 105 days left in 2026. Today Australian Citizenship Day; Christian feast day: Albert of Vercelli; Christian feast day: Ariadne of Phrygia; Christian feast day: Blessed Cecilia Eusepi. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1969 — Keith Flint, English singer-songwriter (died 2019)
- 1946 — Billy Bonds, English footballer and manager (died 2025)
- 1962 — Paul Feig, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1940 — Peter Lever, English cricketer (died 2025)
- 1999 — Daniel Huttlestone, English actor
- 1938 — Perry Robinson, American clarinet player and composer (died 2018)
- 1979 — Billy Miller, American actor(died 2023)
- 1975 — Pumpkinhead, American rapper (died 2015)

THE DAY TODAY

- 2011 — Occupy Wall Street movement begins in Zuccotti Park, New York City.
- 1950 — The Republic of India formally recognised the State of Israel.
- 1978 — The Camp David Accords are signed by Israel and Egypt.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1976 — The Space Shuttle Enterprise is unveiled by NASA.
- 2016 — Two bombs explode in Seaside Park, New Jersey, and Manhattan. Thirty-one people are injured in the Manhattan bombing.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1980 — After weeks of strikes at the Lenin Shipyard in Gdańsk, Poland, the nationwide independent trade union Solidarity is established.
- 2006 — An audio tape of a private speech by Hungarian Prime Minister Ferenc Gyurcsány is leaked to the public, in which he confessed that his Hungarian Socialist Party had lied to win the 2006 election, sparking widespread protests across the country.

- 1961 — Northwest Orient Airlines Flight 706 crashes during takeoff from O'Hare International Airport in Chicago, Illinois, killing all 37 people on board.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 261 of the year, 104 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Ariadne of Phrygia; Christian feast day: Constantius (Theban Legion); Christian feast day: Edward Bouverie Pusey (Episcopal Church); Christian feast day: Eustorgius I. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1950 — Anna Deavere Smith, American actress and playwright
- 1933 — Robert Blake, American actor, producer, and screenwriter (died 2023)
- 1993 — Patrick Schwarzenegger, American-Austrian actor and model
- 1949 — Beth Grant, American actress
- 1973 — James Marsden, American actor
- 1974 — Emily Rutherford, American actress
- 1935 — John Spencer, English snooker player and sportscaster (died 2006)
- 1962 — John Fashanu, English footballer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2015 — Two security personnel, 17 worshippers in a mosque, and 13 militants are killed during a Tehrik-i-Taliban Pakistan attack on a Pakistan Air Force base on the outskirts of Peshawar.
- 2017 — Toy retail chain Toys "R" Us files for bankruptcy protection in the United States and Canada.
- 2011 — The 2011 Sikkim earthquake is felt across northeastern India, Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh and southern Tibet.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2013 — A VIA Rail train crashes into a double-decker bus at a train station in Ottawa, Canada, killing six people and injuring 35 others.
- 2014 — Scotland votes against independence from the United Kingdom, by 55% to 45%.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar